

How the Machine Picks the Two Users Per Topic

The topic's own viral posts tell the machine who the Champions are. It picks the two highest-engagement voices already publicly committed to opposite sides, then filters them down to one pair using a math-based scoring function — not an LLM guess.

The 4-step selection logic

1 · The topic delivers the candidates

- Stage 1's Grok **x_search** already returned the top ratio'd and top opposing posts on the exact claim.
- Every **author** of those posts becomes a pre-qualified candidate — they already publicly staked a position, in the last 7 days, with real engagement attached.
- The machine doesn't hunt users; users self-identified by posting.

2 · Stance classifier splits them

- A small LLM call labels each post: **Side A**, **Side B**, or **noise**.
- Noise = jokes, off-topic, ambiguous, meta-commentary → dropped immediately.
- Result: two buckets of roughly 6–8 candidates each.

3 · Nine features extracted per survivor (in parallel)

- **Conviction** (0–1) · **Reach index** (followers × median engagement) · **Reply-openness** (replies to strangers ratio)
- **Topic fluency** (adjacent posts in last 90d) · **Active timezone** · **Graph distance** to every other candidate
- **Flame tolerance** (sniper / debater / preacher / troll / dry) · **Account health** (bot filter) · **Tag receptivity**
 - Hard gates: no past reply to a stranger → drop. Bot pattern → drop. Drive-by poster → demote.

4 · Pair-scoring picks THE two, not the top two

- A weighted rule engine (not an LLM) scores every **Side-A × Side-B** combination.
- Target ranges: reach ratio 0.5–2.0 · graph distance ≥ 2 (not mutuals) · audience overlap 0.05–0.25
- ≥ 4 waking hours of timezone overlap · style-compatible pairing (sniper/sniper, preacher/preacher)
- Both conviction ≥ 0.7 · both reply-openness ≥ 0.15
 - Top pair = this topic's Champions. Pair #2 and #3 held on the bench for auto-rotation.

Why this works

- **The topic chose the users.** You're not cold-tagging — you're calling out people who already publicly staked a position. That's why they can't ignore it without looking weak.
- **Rules beat LLMs for pairing.** LLMs bias toward famous handles. The rule engine optimizes for engagement probability (weight class + style + timezone + openness).
- **The match is bespoke to each piece of content.** Every Regenerate produces up to 8 cards; each card gets its own pair. No global user list, no favorites.

Per-Content Mapping & Engagement Flow

Which user lands on which artifact

Artifact	Tags / references
Main X post	No tags (algorithm prefers untagged top-level posts)
X reply #1	@Champion A — with their own verbatim quote
X reply #2	@Champion B — with their own verbatim quote
X reply #3 (optional)	Polymarket chart · no user tag
Truth Social post	No tags — amplifies to 42k, drives scoreboard traffic
Blog article (Betty)	Embeds both Champions' posts · no direct tags
Scoreboard page	Side A reserved for @Champion A, Side B for @Champion B
T+45m fallback reply	Direct reply on each Champion's own qualifying post (if no bite)

The engagement sequence for that pair

- **T = 0** · Main X post drops via scheduler at an irregular time (e.g., 7:42am). Untagged, 1600×900 native image showing both quotes, scoreboard link.
- **T + 5 min** · Self-reply tagging **@Champion A** with their verbatim quote + “still standing behind this?”
- **T + 7 min** · Self-reply tagging **@Champion B** — same structure, mirror framing.
- **T + 12 min** · Optional Polymarket chart reply · **T + 15 min** · Truth Social amplification drives spectator traffic to scoreboard.
- **T + 45 min** · Conditional: direct reply on each Champion's *original* qualifying post — only if neither has bitten.
- **Every 30 min** · Agitation loop: odds-shift replies, tribe-summons, auto-rotate to bench Champion at T+3h if one side ghosts.

Through-line across every surface

- **One topic → one pair → same pair referenced everywhere.**
- The Champions are the through-line across all five artifacts.
- Every surface points back to the **same scoreboard, the same two handles, the same one bet.**
- Spectator counter on the scoreboard aggregates Truth Social + X traffic — social proof is cumulative, not per-channel.

In one line

*The Champions are not persuaded — they are trapped into a public choice between defending their stated position or folding in front of their own audience. Clicking **Accept** becomes the least-expensive option available.*